



Manish Sharma at Gatishakti

the three formats (T20, One Days, Tests) have different learnings. You have to continuously imagine, plan, adjust, think, and then execute.”

College and financial crisis

When you get born in an established family and are given almost everything a child can dream of in school days, you quickly draw assumptions about how cool your life is going to be once you join a college for higher studies. But this was not the case with Manish.

“My father tried his hands at business when I was 16, and we started facing several difficulties. I think those financial difficulties were why I promised myself to establish a career as a professional, and also stay away from business,” says Manish.

It is interesting to note here that Manish, while choosing what he would be studying in the 11th and 12th standard, changed his mind at the last minute. He wanted to either pursue commerce or biology, but instead went ahead with mathematics. Part influenced by the developments happening around him, and part influenced by what his best friend wanted to study, Manish went ahead and decided to be an engineer. Manish was always among the top five students of the class, but he was unclear about what he wanted to do in life. He has always counted himself in the list of people who take life and address situ-

ations as they come.

Talking about his close friend, he says, “I asked him to take biology, but he said how can we live our lives without being engineers. We both loved electronics, and electronics has a close association with engineering. Germany has always been known for its engineers and this friend’s father often visited Germany as an engineer. My friend said we will get to visit Germany once we become engineers and hence started the journey of becoming one,” he shares jokingly.

The mountain of difficulties and financial instability started haunting the Sharma family when the business that Manish’s father was trying hands at started going south.

“It is not just about facing difficulties as a family but also about witnessing behavioural changes from your near and dear ones. My family never let me feel the hardships. I could only sense something was wrong whenever I returned home from hostel during holidays. My mother took care of the house, and my father was trying hands at one thing or the other. I think I learned the art of handling and addressing crises from him,” he shares.

Manish explains how he learnt to remain calm in tough times from his parents during the financial crisis situation. The situation that lasted over four years made the family go

through bounce-backs, losses, and a lot of other hardships. The situation only kept worsening before Manish’s father went back to work as a professional in the textile industry. Manish’s mother, during this entire time, made sure that her children were insulated from the situation, so that they could concentrate on studies. Manish now makes sure to insulate his team when hardships fall upon Panasonic, and he is super proud that he has learnt it from his mother.

“I try to become an insulator of sorts for my teams here at Panasonic. Experiences like those inculcate such strong habits in you. If you have to bring the best out of people you do not sit inside their heads. A guardrail has to be provided to people because they have to gain maturity continuously. You have to give them the freedom to learn, explore, and express,” he shares.

Arms drop, and the first job

The best way to enquire about open jobs today is probably through internet. You can search a company’s website for open positions, and at the same time leave your profile on several job portals. Manish, however, belongs to a decade when job hunting meant hopping from one office to another, from one city to another, dropping resumes physically, and repeating the whole process in case you were not satisfied with the job you got.

Manish was not able to secure a job through the campus placement route, and hence began the journey mentioned above. He was able to secure a job in Delhi with help from a connection of his. Manish got placed in Dharuhera in Haryana. The building of this company was still under construction. Manish, within an hour of reaching the project site, realised that this was not the place he wanted to be in.

“I landed a job in Delhi with a company which was into manufacturing of fibre-optic cables. Despite the huge pressure of getting settled and